

Independent certified nurse-midwife practice Some states permit midwives to practice without a doctor in the office. If this type of care is available in your area and you have a low-risk pregnancy, you can see midwives for all of your appointments, and a midwife would be present at your delivery in a hospital, birthing center, or at home. The midwives generally have arrangements with doctors, who are available for consultations as needed.



Midwives may provide care at doctors' offices, maternity centers, or their own practices.

Where you give birth

This important decision doesn't have to be made at your initial appointment, but your midwife or doctor may discuss the options at this time. It's wise to be aware of the risks, benefits, and consequences of your choice. If you have a preexisting problem, or one